



Snap filters on vidcons

We know you want to do this, so here is a guide on how to use Snapchat AR filters on your video calls. <https://digit.in/aug20-99>



IBM's letter to Congress

Read the original letter by IBM CEO Arvind Krishna on their plans for AI based face recognition. <https://digit.in/aug20-100>

HOT OR NOT

lighting. You can't be caught dead with a phosphorus bulb, and the fan definitely needs a deep clean, because let's face it, the webcam is going to fall off at some point and point in that direction. In short, the room that you use for video conferencing probably needs a complete makeover, down to the arrangement of items on the shelf behind you, as well as the choice of books that you want to show off to your audience. Maybe replace that Billie Piper biography with something more cerebral like The Victorian Country House.



SNAP LENSES

One of the easy fixes for getting a spanking new Zoom Room is to just use the background replacement feature, which does not work in bad lighting conditions. But that is still an ama-



AIR BRIDGES

While the pandemic has brought international movement of travellers to a standstill, some countries are selectively opening up routes between themselves, in what are called air bridges, travel bubbles or travel corridors. Almost always, the outbreak is under control in the countries



BLM

The killing of George Floyd followed by the mass protests around the world against systemic racial discrimination has had its ripple effects in the field of technology. Github and OpenZFS have become the latest companies to commit to removing the words "master" and "slave" from their vocabulary. Computer security companies, programming environments and other systems are also moving away from the "blacklist" and "whitelist" terms and are instead using "allow" and "deny" lists. These include Android, Go, Curl and PHPUnit. One of the earliest companies to move away from a racially charged vocabulary was Drupal, which took the necessary action in 2014 itself.

Towards the goal of addressing racial equality in the US, major tech companies have come forward and taken major steps. IBM has announced that it will stop developing AI based face recognition tools which can be used for mass surveillance, and will no longer be selling general purpose face recognition software. Amazon has introduced a one year moratorium on the use of its AI based engine, Rekognition by law enforcement agencies. The moratorium will be extended unless the US Congress introduces strong laws that ensures the ethical use of such software. Microsoft followed suit, also committing to not sell AI based face recognition software to police forces, till such time as there are strong regulations for it. 



Compared to this, virtual backgrounds are so passe

teur move, and not as impressive as using full blown Snapchat AR filters in your Zoom calls. Zoom is no longer used only in the professional realm, with friends and families using the service as well, and the Snap AR filters are great for these more casual Zoom calls. How is this possible you might ask? Well it takes a little bit of effort but is totally worth it. First, you need to download the Snap Camera software, then in the Zoom settings use this software as the video input.

or regions participating in such arrangements. The UK has published a long list of countries from which travellers will not require any quarantine period. There is a limited travel bubble between Australia and New Zealand. The Baltic nations of Estonia, Latvia and Lithuania have a travel agreement among themselves. India is also considering such agreements with a number of countries including the US, Canada, UK, Germany and France. Till such time